

news feed

DIGIT FEBRUARY 2003

hypothesis

Media2Go

■ What is it?

A new software environment by Microsoft for portable video players.

■ How does it work?

Media2Go is based on the next version of the Windows CE .NET OS, currently code-named McKendric. It uses the OS' unique synchronisation, user interface and media experience software technologies to provide the easiest way to enjoy video, music and pictures stored on any Windows-based personal computer on the go.

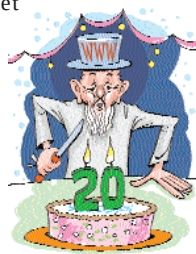
■ What does it do?

Most player devices support audio in only one format, leaving the rest of your video, music and digital photo collection stored and experienced on your PC. Media2Go offers a complete media experience support letting you play and store up to 40 GB of MPEG, MP3 and Windows Media Audio and Video formats wherever you go. It will also let you upload, store and view pictures from your digital camera. It will bring optional hardware connectivity for TV or stereo system synchronisation and a battery life of 6 hours. Microsoft is working with a variety of technology partners to bring Media2Go to customers. Intel has created an xScale-based hardware platform that is currently available.

Happy Birthday, Dear Internet

This year the Internet celebrates its 20th birthday. While some claim that the origins of the Internet actually come from Dr Leonard Kleinrock's paper on packet

switching technology at MIT, in 1961, other historians would fix the year to 1969, when the US Department of Defense commissioned the ARPANET (Advanced Research Projects Agency Network). This was set up to research a communication and command network that could withstand a nuclear



attack. Over the following decade, there were several interesting developments that shaped the Internet as we know it today—the advent of e-mail and the separation of the Internet from the Defense Department. Back then, the Internet used the Network Control Protocol that provided rudimentary Internetting, but was not suited for larger networks. Today, India is still waiting for a speedy access to the Net—well beyond the phone lines most of us still depend on.

SPecially bright

In a single stroke, game hardware and software giant Nintendo has banished two major concerns that hounded its newest handheld, the Game Boy Advance. Addressing a genuine shortcoming of the device, an absence of any form of screen lighting, the company has announced that come March 2003, a newer model titled Game Boy Advance SP will include lighting along the screen's edge and a funky clamshell design will protect the screen. The SP has a 2.4x1.6-inch screen and folds into a 3-inch square, about an inch thick, making it half as small as its elder sibling.



Moreover, the unit will feature another first—a rechargeable battery that is expected to power the device for 10 hours with on-screen light and 18 hours without lighting.

Nintendo has sold more than 150 million units of its various Game Boy editions and enjoys a healthy domination in the handheld gaming market. The Game Boy Advance SP is expected to arrive on international shores around the March 23.

World's Largest TFT LCD TV

Samsung has just unveiled the world's largest TFT LCD TV at iCES 2003. Measuring all of 54 inches, it gives you crisper images, higher resolutions and far less power consumption. The TFT LCD TV is a mere 2 inches in thickness and weighs 44 pounds, making wall mounting easy. It sports a resolution of 1920x1080 and 16:9 screen ratio; it is fully HD compliant and will accommodate all future changes in broadcast technology. The other performance specs are impressive too—with a response time of less than 12 ms, you will get smooth playback for all action-packed scenes. In addition, it is designed for convergence and will double up as a high-resolution WXGA PC monitor. With clear, crisp and bright images, here comes a TV set that will dominate the living room.



snapshot

High demand for Samsung colour handsets account for **10% of the 390 million handsets sold in 2002**

Source: Motorola Inc